



# Opportunities And Challenges For DRONES IN THE MINING SECTOR



The Centre has introduced 'The Drone Rules, 2021' to regulate the use and operation of drones in India. It is safe to say that drones are heralded to bring about major changes in modernising various sectors in the country. A glimpse of it can already be seen with how fast it has transformed agriculture in the country, which has inadvertently resulted in various new agri-tech companies coming up.

The mining sector is envisioned to increase the GDP contribution in India from 1.75% to 2.5% in the financial year 2022-23. However, one of the setbacks that the industry faces is its trepidation to adopt newer, faster technologies. Mining companies have realised how drones, as miniaturised flying machines, help the industry not only save time and money but also provide access to the inaccessible, besides having a lasting impact on safety and health regulations in the mining sector

ASSOCHAM and  
SIDDHA DHAR

**W**hile the use of drones in mining was at a validation stage till a few years ago, it has now crossed that stage and reached a point where we see an early adoption of drone technology throughout the lifecycle of a mine, starting from the exploration phase to the operations, right till the closure phase. "The tangible value that drones as a technology bring into mining has crossed the early adoption phase. We have reached the stage where we are

now seeing a larger, quicker adoption of drones happening in mining," notes Mrinal Pai, COO and Co-founder, Skylark Drones.

The notable amendment made to the drone policy in 2021 stands as a testament to how the industries across the board have started to recognise the importance of drones as a technology. "I think that's a recognition to what drones technology has been doing across multiple industries and we believe that mining in specific has